

Prahl Portfolio Work Log - October 4, 2026

Compiled summary for Sunday, October 4, 2026 - focus: continuing the PrahL.dev Portfolio after the October 2 responsive hero, workspace, and navigation record; independently verifying the United States Eastern date; running the customary project reader; extracting and studying all forty-seven pre-existing Portfolio PDF worklogs; streamlining snapshot generation; reordering landing navigation and content flow; designing and implementing a reusable six-decision UI/UX showcase; refining compact hero quote, profile, and device behavior across portrait, near-square, and compact-landscape breakpoints; expanding the Work Space hardware record with current workstation and dual-monitor specifications; preserving the detached local Next.js preview; validating TypeScript and live routes; documenting committed source state 911f700; refreshing the Portfolio project snapshot; and generating the October 4 Portfolio PDF worklog.

Generated in continuity with the established Prahl Portfolio daily worklog cadence: compact opening summary, source-material section, baseline section, goal list, work-completed sections, committed-source sequence, validation section, files-touched list, follow-up context, and output-artifact close.

This artifact intentionally covers Portfolio work performed after portfolio_worklog_october2.pdf and its documentation commit 6cc45e6. The source work is represented by commits c9f7168, 0c4673c, d5de419, c88eafb, and 911f700 on main, matching origin/main before this PDF was generated. Together they changed the project snapshot workflow, landing navigation and section order, the landing UI/UX presentation, responsive hero geometry and runtime centering, and the Work Space hardware inventory. No Hostinger deploy-branch work, GitHub Actions dispatch, static production publish, or public deployment was performed during this record. The documentation deltas created by this generation pass are the refreshed portfolio_PROJECT_SNAPSHOT.txt file and this root-level October 4 PDF worklog.

Source Materials Reviewed

- Verified the United States Eastern date through an independent UTC-04:00 time query, which reported October 4, 2026 at 1:11 AM. October 4 remains within Eastern Daylight Time, so the filename and title use Sunday, October 4, 2026 rather than relying on the execution host or UTC calendar date.
- Ran ./read_project.sh from /Users/prahlin/gh/portfolio and regenerated portfolio_PROJECT_SNAPSHOT.txt before composing this record, preserving the established source, asset, configuration, Git, PDF-inventory, and workflow-context capture practice.
- Extracted and studied all forty-seven pre-existing root-level Portfolio PDF worklogs with pdftotext and pdfinfo: fifteen July records, fifteen August records, fifteen September records, and the October 1 and October 2 records. Before this artifact, the series contained 272 PDF pages, 131,408 extracted words, and approximately 983,204 extracted characters.
- Compared the complete record set for month-name filenames, non-zero-padded day numbers, same-day Part suffix behavior, title construction, summary density, source and baseline framing, goal lists, technical bullet voice, validation language, files-touched treatment, follow-up continuity, dated page footers, and output-artifact closure.
- Used October 2 as the direct chronological baseline, October 1 for the current landing-hero quote and Cinerific UI Foundations context, September 29 Part 2 for workflow and proof composition continuity, and the mature July-through-September series for document typography, metadata, page geometry, and narrative cadence.
- Checked representative early, middle, and latest files with pdfinfo and pdffonts. The mature convention remains unencrypted US Letter at 612 x 792 points, PDF 1.4, Helvetica and Helvetica-Bold, dense black-on-white technical copy, Codex metadata, and a repeated title-and-page footer.
- Reviewed the five post-worklog commits through git log, git show, commit bodies, and file statistics. Confirmed main and origin/main both resolve to 911f7006887287f422118274dc91bef650fbf0a2, titled Expanded Work Space Hardware Details.
- Reviewed app/page.tsx, app/globals.css, app/PortfolioSections.tsx, app/UiUxDecisionShowcase.tsx, app/ProjectCarouselButton.tsx, read_project.sh, and the refreshed snapshot as the implementation and documentation surface for this record.

Baseline Status Before October 3-4 Work

- The October 2 state had improved compact hero scaling, rebuilt Work Space and Work Tools, and expanded navigation anchors, but the landing page still lacked a dedicated UI/UX section even though UI / UX appeared high in the shared navigation.

- The landing sequence still placed Work Space before Workflow and Core Beliefs, which no longer matched the requested navigation order. The snapshot script also scanned more filesystem state than necessary and retained archived Next.js build output in its inventory.
- The hero's narrow device frames did not maintain equal horizontal center spacing with protected outer gutters across the full 360px-to-720px range. Near-square widths could briefly expose a small three-line quote between otherwise consistent four-line compact layouts.
- The quote/profile group and device group used overlapping absolute geometry in compact layouts. Several successive corrections were needed to separate the vertical bands, restore intended device positions, then tighten the perceived silhouette gap rather than relying only on rectangular image bounds.
- The 981px-to-1023px compact-landscape state changed chips and proof items into left-side columns while runtime hero centering counteracted intentional device-stage movement, leaving a large empty corridor above the stats strip.
- Work Space still labeled its primary hardware row WORK STATION / Laptop and summarized the MacBook in one short line. External displays were listed as two CMV 14-inch units rather than the current pair of largest-size WCV portable monitors.

Goals for October 4

- Reduce snapshot noise and generation cost while preserving the complete tracked, non-ignored project record expected by future sessions.
- Align landing content order with navigation order and introduce a distinctive but restrained UI/UX section high on the page, using reusable data, replaceable screenshots, and editable connector geometry.
- Make compact hero behavior continuous: equal device distribution at the narrowest widths, a fixed large four-line quote whenever the hero images appear below the copy, deliberate quote/profile and device stack spacing, and no transient small-quote state.
- Add a protected compact-landscape device snap when chips and proof content collapse into the left column, without moving the quote, profile, copy, proof panel, stats strip, or horizontal device coordinates.
- Rename and expand the Work Space hardware row into a specifications-only workstation record based on the current MacBook and dual WCV display setup, while keeping the data and rendering reusable.

Work Completed - Snapshot Generation and Content Order

- Replaced the snapshot script's broad filesystem tree scan with Git-tracked and non-ignored file discovery. Reinforced exclusions for .next and archived .next.* directories, generated caches, private material, and platform-specific noise.
- Regenerated the project snapshot after the script change and reduced the recorded file surface substantially while retaining source, assets, route structure, repository state, worklog inventory, and session guidance needed for future continuity.
- Reordered shared navigation to CASES, UI / UX, STACK, FLOW, VALUES, SPACE, and CONTACT. Preserved the two-row responsive navigation behavior, brand spacing, project navigation instances, and context-aware home hash routing.
- Moved Work Space and Work Tools below My Workflow and My Core Beliefs so the landing page now follows the same top-to-bottom story advertised by the navigation. The change reused existing sections rather than cloning content.

Work Completed - Reusable Landing UI/UX Decision Showcase

- Added a dedicated landing UI/UX section immediately after Featured Case Studies and before the technology stack. Updated the shared UI / UX navigation destination from /articles to the new #uiux landing anchor while preserving article-page behavior.
- Created UiUxDecisionShowcase as a reusable component rather than a one-off drawing. Its public inputs include six decision objects, eyebrow, title, subtitle, screenshot source and alternative text, object-fit behavior, and object-position behavior.
- Defined all six numbered decision blocks in landing-page data so labels and descriptions can be edited independently. Each decision also owns reusable SVG noodle points, allowing connector direction and shape to be tuned without rewriting component markup.
- Built the central phone as a CSS device frame with a distinct replaceable screenshot layer. The frame, speaker and camera details remain presentation code, while a future screenshot can be supplied through screenshotSrc without modifying the component structure.

- Implemented a wide composition with three numbered decisions on each side of the device and connector noodles leading toward the screen. Implemented a portrait composition with decisions 01-03 above the device and 04-06 below it, matching the accepted mockup logic.
- Kept the section visually related to the portfolio through the existing dark green grid, mint text, fine borders, rounded cards, and typographic hierarchy while avoiding the stacked-card, tab, and circular-orbit structures already used elsewhere.

Work Completed - Narrow Hero Distribution and Quote Treatment

- Replaced edge-stuck narrow-device placement with one responsive horizontal distribution system. Alla Vostra, Cinerific, and CreditKing now maintain equal center-to-center spacing and approximately 32px outer gutters across tested 360px, 390px, 430px, 560px, and 720px widths.
- Preserved each device's established vertical position while correcting only its horizontal formula. The outer phones use viewport-aware left and right calculations, while the tablet remains centered through a calculated left coordinate.
- Promoted the 721px-to-980px compact quote to the same fixed 31.745px four-line treatment used by the narrowest layout. Standard three-line rows are hidden and the existing four semantic narrow rows are shown, keeping copy and punctuation identical.
- Restored the desktop quote's 80fr / text / 20fr horizontal weighting in compact layouts. This biases the paragraph toward the profile bubble rather than centering it between the device composition's left edge and the portrait.
- Separated quote/profile and device presentation into controlled vertical bands, then visually tightened the space by moving the upper group down and the lower device group up. Adjustments were based on rendered silhouettes and protected horizontal boundaries rather than raw image-box values alone.
- Removed the near-square small-quote flash by tying the fixed large quote to the single-column hero state, where images appear below the copy, instead of relying solely on the browser's portrait orientation classification.
- Extended the compact single-column portrait composition through 1040px and moved the full desktop transition to 1041px. Updated runtime two-column detection to use the same threshold while retaining desktop behavior for true 981px-and-up landscape layouts.

Work Completed - Compact-Landscape Device Snap

- Identified 1024px landscape as the proof-layout transition: at 1024px the proof panel uses six columns, while 1023px and below returns to three columns and confines chips and proof content to the left side of the two-column hero.
- Added a device-stage-only snap for 981px through 1023px landscape. The CSS exposes --hero-device-stage-snap and translates only .phone-stage by 140 CSS pixels, leaving the quote, profile, hero copy, chips, proof, stats, and all horizontal positions unchanged.
- Updated ProjectCarouselButton's runtime centering calculation to recognize the intentional snap. The geometry pass subtracts the scaled snap only from device-frame measurements, preventing the parent hero visual offset from canceling the requested movement.
- After clearing stale Next.js output, measured approximately 126 rendered pixels of downward device movement at the target transition and reduced the visible device-to-stats corridor by roughly 100px without altering neighboring element coordinates.

Work Completed - Work Space Hardware Expansion

- Renamed the green eyebrow from WORK STATION to HARD / WARE through the existing two-word label renderer and renamed the white Laptop heading to Workstation. Accessible labeling continues to expose the complete HARD WARE text.
- Replaced the one-line MacBook summary with a reusable workstationSpecs collection rendered as labeled rows. The block contains specifications only, with no promotional or explanatory sentences.
- Recorded MacBook Air / 15-inch / 2025, Apple M4 with a 10-core CPU split into four performance and six efficiency cores, integrated 10-core GPU with Metal 4, 16GB unified memory, and the user-specified 128GB internal SSD.
- Added Liquid Retina 2880 x 1864, current 1920 x 1080 at 60Hz display output, and macOS Tahoe 26.6.2. Deliberately omitted the machine serial number from the public portfolio even though it appeared in the supplied About This Mac reference.

- Renamed External Monitor to External Monitors and replaced both earlier CMV entries with matching WCV 15.6-inch 1080p IPS displays, reflecting the current dual-monitor setup and the largest WCV portable size identified for the record.
- Added responsive specification-row styling with green uppercase labels, white values, fine separators, and a two-column grid that wraps cleanly on narrow screens while retaining the established Work Space rail and typography.

Work Completed - Local Preview, Cache Handling, and Documentation

- Maintained the local Next.js preview in the detached portfolio-dev screen session at 127.0.0.1:3000. Restarted it only when compiled CSS or client geometry logic demonstrably remained stale after source edits.
- Moved stale .next directories to timestamped /tmp locations before clean restarts instead of deleting broad paths. Terminated exact orphaned dev-process identifiers when screen sessions exited without their Next.js children.
- Used Playwright with the installed Google Chrome binary to inspect computed styles, rendered bounds, breakpoint transitions, line visibility, center spacing, outer gutters, stack gaps, and screenshots at representative desktop, portrait, near-square, and compact-landscape widths.
- Refreshed portfolio_PROJECT_SNAPSHOT.txt after the committed application work. The resulting file records 16,894 lines and 563,843 bytes at committed source state 911f700 plus the documentation pass.

Committed Source Sequence

- c9f7168 - Streamlined Project Snapshot Generation. Replaced broad filesystem scanning with Git-aware discovery, expanded cache and archive exclusions, and reduced snapshot noise.
- 0c4673c - Refined Landing Navigation and Content Flow. Reordered navigation, preserved responsive row behavior, and moved Work Space below Workflow and Core Beliefs.
- d5de419 - Added Reusable Landing UI/UX Decision Showcase. Added the six-decision component, editable noodles, replaceable screenshot frame, responsive arrangements, landing data, and #uiux navigation target.
- c88eafb - Refined Responsive Hero Layout Across Compact Breakpoints. Standardized four-line quote behavior, extended compact portrait layout, corrected narrow device distribution, tightened vertical stacks, and aligned runtime centering with targeted breakpoint offsets.
- 911f700 - Expanded Work Space Hardware Details. Renamed the hardware row, introduced reusable specifications, recorded the current MacBook configuration, updated both WCV displays, and styled the expanded block responsively.

Validation Summary

- Ran npm run check after the final application changes and during this documentation pass; TypeScript completed successfully with no emitted files.
- Confirmed main and origin/main both resolve to 911f7006887287f422118274dc91bef650bf0a2 before generating the PDF. The only pre-PDF working-tree change after the final source commit was the customary refreshed portfolio_PROJECT_SNAPSHOT.txt.
- Loaded / and /articles through the persistent local server and confirmed HTTP 200 responses for both routes. The preview remained available at <http://127.0.0.1:3000>.
- Verified compact quote font size, row visibility, portrait/near-square continuity, two-column desktop reentry, and runtime offset removal at the 1040px-to-1041px boundary.
- Measured equal narrow-device center spacing and 32px outer gutters across the tested portrait widths. Verified that compact hero stack changes did not alter protected horizontal placement.
- Measured the compact-landscape proof transition at 1024px/1023px, confirmed the 140px CSS stage snap becomes approximately 126px after hero scaling, and verified quote/profile/proof positions remain stable.
- Verified the Work Space block exposes HARD WARE, Workstation, eight structured specification rows, and two WCV 15.6-inch 1080p IPS entries at desktop, 720px, and 430px viewport widths.

Files Touched and Artifacts

- read_project.sh - changed snapshot discovery to Git-aware tracked and non-ignored inputs and excluded archived Next.js build directories.
- app/PortfolioSections.tsx - reordered shared navigation behavior and redirected UI / UX to the landing #uiux section while preserving article-page context.
- app/UiUxDecisionShowcase.tsx - added the reusable six-decision showcase, SVG connector rendering, configurable screenshot layer, and semantic callout structure.

- app/page.tsx - added UI/UX decision data and placement, reordered landing sections, expanded hero quote markup behavior, and replaced the workstation summary with reusable hardware specs and dual-monitor details.
- app/globals.css - added UI/UX showcase styling, narrow device distribution, compact quote and stack rules, extended portrait behavior, compact-landscape device snapping, and responsive workstation specification rows.
- app/ProjectCarouselButton.tsx - aligned runtime hero mode detection with the 1040px compact threshold and made centering calculations preserve intentional device-stage snaps.
- portfolio_PROJECT_SNAPSHOT.txt - refreshed through ./read_project.sh so the documentation companion records final committed state 911f700 and all forty-seven earlier worklogs.
- portfolio_worklog_october4.pdf - created as the first October 4 Portfolio worklog at the repository root using the established no-Part filename.

Follow-Up Context

- The UI/UX section is intentionally data-driven. Future copy edits belong in uiUxDecisions; connector changes belong in each decision's noodle point list; screenshot replacements should use screenshotSrc, screenshotFit, and screenshotPosition rather than editing frame markup.
- The fixed 31.745px four-line quote belongs only to single-column hero states where the images appear below the copy. True two-column desktop layouts retain the smaller responsive three-line quote.
- The 981px-to-1023px landscape device snap is intentionally isolated to .phone-stage. Its CSS custom property is consumed by runtime geometry code so future offset changes should keep both layers synchronized.
- Narrow device distribution depends on the existing frame widths and rotations. If those assets change, remeasure visible outer gutters and center spacing before revising the viewport formulas.
- Workstation specifications are rendered from workstationSpecs. The 128GB internal capacity is an explicit user-provided portfolio value; do not silently replace it with a formatted or system-reported capacity.
- The serial number remains intentionally absent from public source content. Future hardware updates should continue to exclude unique machine identifiers, UUIDs, and provisioning identifiers.
- The detached portfolio-dev screen session remains the preferred local-preview mechanism. Cache clearing should be reserved for verified stale compiled output and should preserve old .next directories in /tmp when practical.
- As with prior Portfolio work, ask for the commit message before committing or pushing the refreshed snapshot or this PDF unless the user explicitly supplies a message and requests the operation.

Output Artifact

- Created /Users/prahlin/gh/portfolio/portfolio_worklog_october4.pdf as the latest daily worklog for Sunday, October 4, 2026, following the established month-name, non-zero-padded day, and no-Part first-record naming convention.
- Produced an unencrypted US Letter, PDF 1.4 document using Helvetica and Helvetica-Bold with Codex title, subject, author, creator, and producer metadata.
- Preserved the established dense technical narrative, mature section ordering, repeated dated page footer, and end-of-document continuity notes used by the recent Portfolio worklog series.
- Source state reviewed: 911f7006887287f422118274dc91bef650fbf0a2 on main and origin/main before snapshot and PDF generation.
- No application-source change, source commit, push, deployment, Hostinger synchronization, GitHub Actions dispatch, or production publish was performed as part of generating this PDF artifact.